

Six Practical Steps To Be More Inclusive in the Synagogue

#1 Order Large Print Prayer Books

People with low vision will appreciate having a large print siddur. Provide large print machzorim, chumashim, siddurim, birkat hamazon, and other printed materials. Many are free and available at [JBI \(formerly known as the Jewish Braille Institute\)](http://www.jbilibrary.org) for people who have visual impairments, are blind, or have a physical or reading disability.

<http://www.jbilibrary.org>

#2 Add an Inclusion Statement

Include this statement in weekly emails, high holiday information, flyers, invitations, and website:

Chabad is committed to creating an inclusive and welcoming community, both physically and spiritually. If you need an accommodation to participate please let us know! Please call (phone number) or email us at (email address) by (due date).

- Print & hang an [Accommodation Sign](#) at your entrance.

#3 “Please Rise” Language

Some people are not able to stand and may feel uncomfortable when asked to rise for specific services in shul. People really appreciate knowing that it’s okay to stay seated if necessary. Announce that staying seated is acceptable. One example is “*If you are able, please rise.*”

#4 Provide Greeters

Greeters can show people to accessible entrances, find large print or Braille materials if needed, point out accessible restrooms, and find seating and people to sit with.

#5 Access for People Who Use Wheelchairs and Walkers

Make a wide aisle in the sanctuary for people who use assistive mobility devices. Remove chairs throughout the shul so people can sit with family and friends instead of sitting in a “wheelchair section.”

#6 Kiddush and Food Options

Provide allergy friendly options (ex: gluten-free, nut-free, dairy-free) options at events with food. Be sure to label them so people with food sensitivities know they are safe choices. [Click HERE for ideas and printable labels.](#)